



Teacher Manual — Art History and Criticism 1 Honors

CPALMS 0100330 · GRADES 9–12 · FULL YEAR · 250 MIN/WK · OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · 2026–2027

Teacher copy. This manual contains answer keys, rubrics, grading guidance, and sensitive-content notes. **Do not publish it to students** or attach it anywhere in the student-facing course. Keep it in your own files.

How to use this manual

Read Sections 1–3 before your first week: they explain what the course is and what your actual job in it looks like. Sections 6–8 are your grading desk reference. Section 10 gives you a ready announcement for every unit. Section 12 is the standards map (Florida and Texas), including the coverage gaps flagged for revision. Anything the build could not verify is marked **[VERIFY]**.

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1. How this course works

The course follows the AHC Map: **11 units + 2 culminating projects**, Prehistory through Contemporary, split into two self-contained semesters (Units 1–6 + Virtual Museum Exhibit; Units 7–11 + Art Historian Portfolio). Every unit has the same skeleton, so once you have taught Unit 2 you can teach them all. The spine of the whole course is the four-step criticism method taught in Unit 1 (Describe, Analyze, Interpret, Judge). Students see the acronym “DAIJ” only in Unit 1; from Unit 2 on it is called “the four-step method” on student pages, though the four step names stay visible everywhere.

A typical lesson (what a student sees)

Interactive lessons are full HTML pages hosted on GitHub Pages and embedded in Canvas via iframe. Each opens with a real artwork and a wonder-question (“Look First”), then walks through: Today’s Focus · Objectives · What You Need · 2–3 content parts with time-estimate pills · an **Artwork Spotlight** applying the four-step method to the featured work · small self-check widgets (immediate feedback, Reset button, ungraded) · a Vocabulary box · “What You’ll Do

Next” · Wrap-up. Teal blocks mean “look closely / observe”; coral blocks mean “now you try / create.” Coral-framed “WORTH KNOWING” callouts state factually what AI can and cannot do for that task.

A typical unit (2–3 weeks, ~250 min/wk)

SEGMENT	WHAT THE STUDENT DOES	GRADED?	TIER
Module Map page	Reads the unit plan and submission checklist	No	—
Intro wrapper	Canvas Quiz in survey mode: first answer to the essential question, confidence baseline	Completion	4
2–3 interactive lessons	Reads, looks, works the widgets, keeps notebook practice	No	—
Analysis essay	Four-step written analysis of the unit’s masterwork, Word .docx via OneDrive, 40 pts	Yes — rubric	3
Comparison discussion	Canvas Discussion: claim + reasoned reply (e.g. “Greek vs. Roman artistic values”), 20 pts	Yes — light rubric	2
Creation activity	Hands-on piece applying the period’s real convention (cartouche, mosaic, chiaroscuro...), photo + note, 20 pts	Completion + effort	1
Unit quiz	10 questions, auto-graded, 20 pts	Auto	1
VR journal (Units 2 & 5 only)	Virtual museum/architecture visit + placed-note journal	Completion	1
Outro wrapper	Survey quiz: essential question revisited, confidence, what’s unclear, virtue reflection	Completion	4

Major assessments (the year at a glance)

ASSESSMENT	PLACE	PTS	WHAT IT ASKS	YOUR GRADING TIME
Unit Analysis essays (11)	One per unit	40 each	Four-step written analysis of a named masterwork (student chooses between two in U5, U6, U7, U8, U10; selects freely in U11)	~5 min/student each
Virtual Museum Exhibit (CP1)	End of Semester 1	100	Curated PowerPoint exhibit: 5–7 works from Units 1–6, a theme, four-step museum labels, citations, optional VR gallery	~5 min/student at slide level
Art Historian Portfolio (CP2)	End of year	100	Compiled Word portfolio (2+ analyses, 1+ comparison, 1+ creation) + final reflective essay on growth	~10–12 min/student; focus on selection logic + reflection (the pieces were graded before)

2. Teaching it live: the 4-day week

The asynchronous course runs unchanged in a live section; what changes is that you spend the minutes together. Here is a standing weekly rhythm for a section that meets **4 days per week** (~60 min/meeting), followed by unit-

specific notes. The principle: the interactive lessons become guided looking, the discussion becomes a live seminar, the creation becomes studio time, and the analysis stays independent written work.

DAY	LIVE USE OF THE ASYNC MATERIAL
Day 1 — Look First	Open the week’s interactive lesson together on screen or in VR. Project the featured artwork <i>before</i> any reading and run the lesson’s wonder-question aloud: two full minutes of silent looking, then “what do you notice?” around the room. Walk the lesson’s content parts together; students work the self-check widgets on their own devices as you go. End by assigning the remaining lesson(s) as reading before Day 2.
Day 2 — Method practice	Bellwork: one widget round from the second lesson as a warm-up. Then whole-class four-step practice on a <i>new</i> work from the unit (not the analysis subject): you scribe Describe on the board strictly literal, then Analyze, Interpret, Judge in pairs. This is the direct rehearsal for the graded essay. Introduce the Analysis assignment and its rubric; students draft their Describe paragraph in class.
Day 3 — Seminar	Run the unit’s Comparison discussion live as a seminar (the Canvas Discussion prompt is your seminar question, e.g. “Romanticism vs. Realism”). Students still post their claim + one reply in Canvas afterward, which keeps the gradebook identical to the async section. Reserve the last 10 minutes for analysis-drafting questions.
Day 4 — Studio & check	Studio time for the creation activity (cartouche, vase design, chiaroscuro...) with materials out and music on; circulate and name what you see students noticing. Students photograph and submit before leaving. Last 10 minutes: the unit quiz (on quiz weeks) or the outro wrapper survey, done individually. VR journal weeks (U2, U5): run the museum visit together as the Day 4 session.

Pacing the 2–3 week units across 4-day weeks. Week 1 of a unit = Days 1–2 on lesson one + method practice, Days 3–4 seminar prep and studio start. Week 2 = Day 1 on the remaining lesson, Day 2 analysis workshop (drafting in class), Day 3 seminar, Day 4 studio finish + quiz + outro. Three-week units breathe: add a Day 2 “silent gallery” session (all unit images up, students rotate with sticky-note observations) and use the extra Day 4 for peer feedback on analysis drafts before submission. Capstone fortnights (CP1, CP2): Days 1–2 curation/selection workshops, Day 3 peer critique of drafts, Day 4 presentation day; for CP1 assemble the class exhibits into a shared gallery walk (VR or screen-share) and let each curator give a 2-minute tour. That gallery walk is also your best Texas-alignment move; see Section 12.

3. Ungraded interactives & the intro/outro wrappers

The widgets cost you nothing. Self-checks, flip cards, and reflection boxes live on the GitHub-hosted lesson pages, give the student immediate feedback, and produce no submission and no grading. They are formation-by-practice, not busywork to chase. A student who skips them shows up indirectly, in quiz scores and thin Describe paragraphs, not as a missing grade.

The wrappers are survey-mode Canvas Quizzes, not pages, on purpose. The intro captures a first answer to the unit’s essential question and a confidence baseline; the outro captures the revisited answer, a confidence rating, “what still feels unclear,” a virtue reflection, and a seed question for what comes next (the Unit 6 outro asks which work they’d exhibit, feeding CP1; Unit 11’s asks which work they’re proudest of, feeding CP2). Because they are quiz questions, the answers arrive as **sortable cohort data**.

The highest-leverage 20 minutes in this course: after each unit closes, open the outro responses and triage. Sort Q2 (confidence, 1–5) and note every 1–2; skim Q3 (“what’s unclear”) for repeated concepts; skim Q1 for conceptual growth. Then do three things: post one targeted announcement re-teaching the most-repeated confusion, message the low-confidence students individually (warm, specific, short), and note the confusion for your Day 2 method practice if you teach live. Nothing else you do this week moves more students.

4. AI & VR in this course (student-facing)

AI posture: awareness, not required use. Every analysis assignment carries a coral “WORTH KNOWING” callout stating factually what AI can and cannot do for that task; the recurring theme is that AI can generate polished-sounding analysis but invents details that are not in the artwork and cannot verify claims against the image, and that the graded analyses measure the student’s own eye. The CP2 reflection callout makes clear AI cannot supply an honest account of the student’s own growth. No assignment requires any specific AI tool. Do not add new AI requirements; when talking with students, use the callouts’ framing.

VR appears where the Map put it and nowhere else: a Museum Journal in Unit 2, an Architecture Journal in Unit 5, and an *optional* VR gallery on both capstones. Each VR assignment describes what the student does (visit, choose a viewing spot, place notes, capture) and produces a durable artifact submitted in Canvas; each carries a teacher note. The build is deliberately platform-agnostic: it never names a VR platform. Keep it that way in your announcements and feedback. Every VR activity has a stated non-VR alternative path, so no student is blocked by hardware.

5. Using Ignite AI to support students (teacher-facing)

[VERIFY] before leaning on this section: Ignite AI feature names and availability vary by Canvas release and by what Optima has enabled. Confirm the current feature set in Optima’s Canvas instance before promising yourself a workflow. Everything below is described functionally.

With ~500 asynchronous students, the Canvas AI assistant is how feedback stays personal at scale. The standing rule for all of it: **AI drafts, you decide.** You read, edit, and own anything sent to a student or family. Never use it to surveil, rank, or auto-penalize.

- **Drafting individualized analysis feedback.** Paste your rubric scores + one observation, let it draft the paragraph, then edit until it sounds like you. Cuts Tier-3 turnaround; judgment stays yours.
- **Summarizing discussion threads.** Before grading a Comparison discussion, ask for a summary of positions and the strongest/weakest reasoning; grade with the map in hand and drop 2–3 public model comments.
- **Triaging wrapper analytics.** Have it cluster outro Q3 answers (“what’s unclear”) into themes for your re-teach announcement.
- **Surfacing students who need a nudge** (low outro confidence, missed analysis, sliding quiz scores) and drafting the warm check-in you then personalize.
- **Practice variants.** For a student shaky on vocabulary, generate another rep (e.g. five fresh “which principle is at work here?” items) as ungraded practice.

- **Family communication.** Draft clear, kind progress summaries; translate where helpful. Read and edit before sending.

6. Grading categories & Canvas gradebook setup

The syllabus grading policy is fixed: **Major Projects & Assessments 60% · Assignments, Quizzes & Creative Activities 30% · Reflections, Discussions & Participation 10%**. Set up three weighted assignment groups to match:

ASSIGNMENT GROUP (WEIGHT)	WHAT GOES IN IT	GRADING METHOD
Major Projects & Assessments (60%)	11 unit Analysis essays (40 pts each) · CP1 Virtual Museum Exhibit (100) · CP2 Art Historian Portfolio (100)	Canvas rubric in SpeedGrader
Assignments, Quizzes & Creative Activities (30%)	11 unit quizzes (20 pts, auto) · 11 creation activities (20 pts, completion + effort) · VR journals U2 & U5 (completion)	Auto / completion
Reflections, Discussions & Participation (10%)	11 comparison discussions (20 pts, light rubric) · intro/outro wrappers (survey, completion credit)	Light rubric / completion

Setup steps: (1) Assignments › three groups above › group weights ON, 60/30/10. (2) Build each `*-SPEC.md` as a Canvas Quiz: unit quizzes as graded quizzes with shuffle-answers ON; intro/outro wrappers as **ungraded surveys** (or graded-survey for completion points). (3) Build each `*-04-comparison-discussion-SPEC.md` as a graded Discussion, 20 pts. (4) Attach the Section 7 rubric to every analysis and both capstones as a native Canvas Rubric so it scores in SpeedGrader. (5) Set your late policy to match the syllabus (no per-item penalty; end-of-quarter zero; 10% deduction in the final 14 days — the 14-day deduction is applied manually or via your section's configured policy **[VERIFY against current school Canvas policy]**). (6) Turn on module requirements (mark-as-done / submit) so the module-progress view shows completion across the ungraded scaffolding.

Point values above are read from the built assignment pages (40/100/20/20). Discussion and creation point values appear on their pages/SPECs; if any item in your import shows a different value, the built page wins. **[VERIFY]** totals after import.

7. Rubrics & answer keys

The standard analysis rubric (every unit, 40 pts) — use as a native Canvas Rubric

CRITERION (10 PTS EACH)	10 — FULL	7–8 — DEVELOPING	4–6 — PARTIAL	0–3 — MISSING
Describe: accurate, specific, observation only	Literal inventory, specific and complete; no interpretation smuggled in	Mostly literal; one or two vague or interpretive slips	Thin or generic; misses major visible features	Absent or wholly interpretive
Analyze: names 2–3 Elements/Principles and how they work	Specific device tied to specific effect, 2–3 elements/principles named correctly	Elements named but effects loosely argued	Lists terms without connecting them to the work	No formal analysis
Interpret: meaning tied to visual evidence	Defensible reading that traces back to Describe/Analyze observations	Reasonable reading, evidence link partly implicit	Opinion with little anchoring in the work	No interpretation or pure summary
Judge + vocabulary: reasoned verdict, correct art terms	Verdict measured against the work's own goal; unit vocabulary used correctly	Verdict present, criteria fuzzy; minor term misuse	"I like it / I don't" without criteria	No judgment

The per-unit "model notes" in Section 8 tell you what full-credit Describe/Analyze/Interpret/Judge looks like for that unit's specific artwork. Both capstones carry their own 4-criterion, 100-pt rubric on the assignment page (CP1: theme & curation, label quality, historical context & citations, craft of the presentation; CP2 adds the reflection as the graded heart); use the rubric printed on each assignment page as the Canvas rubric.

Discussion rubric (every comparison, 20 pts)

LEVEL	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	PTS
Substantive	A clear claim comparing the two traditions, supported by at least one named work/feature, plus one reasoned reply that engages a classmate's point	18–20
Thin	Claim or reply present but generic; little visual evidence	12–16
Minimal / missing	One-liner, off-prompt, or no reply	0–10

Quiz answer keys

Every unit quiz is 10 questions, auto-graded, 20 pts, built from its `U#-06-quiz-SPEC.md`, where the correct options are marked with . Enter them with answer shuffling on. Keys for Units 7–11 are also transcribed in each unit's teacher guide (`teacher-guide/` folder, both semesters). There are **no free-response questions on any graded quiz** (free-response prompts live only in the ungraded survey wrappers), so the analysis and discussion rubrics above are the complete scoring apparatus. Never post keys, rubricbed model answers, or these guides to students.

8. Running & grading each item, unit by unit

General moves by type: **Analyses** — one rubric pass, ~5 min/student; use the model notes below; feedback names the next step. **Discussions** — batch-read on the substantive/thin/missing rubric; drop 2–3 public model comments naming good thinking. **Creations** — completion + effort; look for the period convention actually applied, the

required signature, and the artist's note; celebrate rather than critique. **Quizzes** — auto; scan the item analysis for any question missed by half the cohort and re-teach it. **VR journals** — completion; read for one genuine observation. **Wrappers** — completion; triage per Section 3.

UNIT	T3 ANALYSIS (40)	T2 DISCUSSION (20)	T1 CREATION (20)	GRADING NOTE FOR THE ANALYSIS
1 • Introduction to Art History & Criticism (2 wk)	Formal Analysis of a selected artwork (student names title/artist/date at top)	Art History vs. Art Criticism	Elements & Principles Design Challenge	First rubric pass of the year: grade generously on Interpret/Judge, firmly on Describe discipline (observation only). This sets the tone for all 11.
2 • Prehistoric Art (2 wk)	Lascaux Cave Painting Analysis	Lascaux vs. Stonehenge as cultural artifacts	Prehistoric Symbol Painting	Reward interpretation held honestly as <i>theory</i> (no written record exists); penalize confident claims about “what it meant.” + VR Museum Journal (completion).
3 • Ancient Egypt & Mesopotamia (3 wk)	Palette of Narmer Analysis	Egyptian vs. Mesopotamian art & architecture	Egyptian Cartouche Design	Full credit Analyze names hierarchical scale, registers, and composite view and ties each to the unification message.
4 • Ancient Greece (3 wk)	Parthenon Analysis	Egyptian vs. Greek sculpture	Greek Vase Narrative Design	Look for Doric order vocabulary, entasis/refinements, and Judge measured against Classical ideals of proportion.
5 • Ancient Rome (2–3 wk)	Augustus of Prima Porta or Colosseum (student chooses)	Greek vs. Roman artistic values	Roman Mosaic Design (digital option allowed: spreadsheet, pixel-art app, or drawing program)	Augustus papers should read the propaganda program (verism abandoned, ideal youth, cuirass imagery); Colosseum papers the engineering (arch, concrete, crowd logistics). + VR Architecture Journal.
6 • Byzantine, Islamic & Medieval Art (3 wk)	Hagia Sophia or a Gothic cathedral (student chooses)	Byzantine vs. Gothic visual traditions	Illuminated Manuscript Page	Hagia Sophia: pendentives, dome-on-square, light as theology. Gothic: pointed arch, flying buttress, walls-into-windows. Outro Q5 seeds CP1; read those answers.
CP1 • Virtual Museum Exhibit (end S1)	100-pt PowerPoint exhibit; rubric on the assignment page	—	—	Grade at slide level: theme coherence, label quality (four-step in miniature), citations, craft. PD/CC images only; in-copyright works linked, never pasted. After the deadline, run the Class Gallery Walk (assemble exhibits into a shared gallery or Canvas Discussion; students leave docent comments on two classmates’ exhibits, completion credit); live sections may offer the partner-exhibit option. Recipe in the CP1 teacher guide.
7 • Renaissance Art (3 wk)	Mona Lisa or School of Athens (student chooses)	Medieval vs. Renaissance worldviews	One-Point Perspective Drawing (construction	Mona Lisa: sfumato, pyramid pose, humanism/naturalism. School of Athens: orthogonals converging between the central figures.

			rung: horizon line, vanishing point, orthogonals required)	Common miss: biography instead of looking; push back to the surface.
8 • Baroque & Rococo (2–3 wk)	Calling of St. Matthew <i>or</i> Ecstasy of St. Teresa (Teresa is student-researched)	Renaissance vs. Baroque art	Chiaroscuro Drawing or Photography Challenge (one deliberate light source; note names what light reveals/hides)	Full credit Analyze names tenebrism/chiaroscuro and the diagonal light shaft directing the eye; Judge measures against Baroque's own goal of drama, not modern taste.
9 • Neoclassicism, Romanticism & Realism (3 wk)	The Stone Breakers Analysis	Romanticism vs. Realism	Historical Narrative Sketch	Full credit: life-size scale + figures at the picture plane, muted palette, averted faces as types; Interpret as social commentary tied to those features. Common slip: calling Realism "Romantic" — absence of drama is the point.
10 • Impressionism & Post-Impressionism (2 wk)	Monet, Renoir, or Cassatt (student chooses)	Academic Art vs. Impressionism	Color & Light Study (photo + 2–3 sentence note, no .docx)	Reward specific broken-brushwork/optical-color observations tied to effects; Judge against the goal of catching a passing moment of light, not "finish."
11 • Modern & Contemporary Art (3 wk)	Student-selected modern/contemporary work — linked, never embedded (title, artist, date + working museum link required at top)	Modern vs. Contemporary art	Movement-Inspired Artwork (applies a movement's idea; never copies a piece)	Rubric rewards a working museum link and verified facts. No artwork images anywhere in this unit — the strict link-out policy is deliberate; keep it. Outro Q5 seeds CP2.
CP2 • Art Historian Portfolio (end of year)	100-pt compiled Word portfolio + reflection; rubric on the assignment page		—	Most pieces were graded before: spend your fresh reading on the selection logic and the reflective essay (the graded heart; must be specific, honest, tied to actual pieces).

9. Coach, not catch

Your job is to move each student's eye and writing forward, not to detect and punish. In practice:

- Feedback names the next step, not just the error, and leads with what is working ("Your Describe is genuinely literal — now make Analyze point at one specific brushstroke").
- Tier-1 practice (creations, quizzes where re-attempts are configured) is a learning tool, not a trap; allow the retake.

- Use the outro analytics and Ignite AI to **find** students who need help early, then reach out warmly; never to build a case.
- On suspected AI misuse or dishonesty: open a conversation. Ask the student to walk you through their looking (“show me where in the painting you saw that”). In this course the tell is claims that are not in the image; treat the conversation as formation, not accusation.
- Public discussion comments model good thinking; they never single out weak work.

10. Weekly announcement scripts

Asynchronous students experience you mostly through the weekly announcement. Clone this template, then use the drafted unit scripts. Keep them short and human; fill the brackets.

[Unit N, Week X] template. “This week you’re in [unit/lesson]. The one thing not to miss: [the graded item + due date]. A tip for it: [one concrete pointer]. [One warm sentence noticing something real from last week’s work.] Office hours [time]; come look at art with me.”

U1. Welcome to Art History & Criticism! This week: Lessons 1.01 and 1.02, where you learn the four-step method you’ll use all year. Don’t miss the Formal Analysis [due date]: pick a work you actually want to stare at, and remember to put its title, artist, and date at the top of your document. The Now You Try boxes are practice, nothing to turn in.

U2. This week you meet the oldest art on Earth. As you write your Lascaux Analysis [due date], hold your interpretation honestly: nobody alive knows what these paintings meant, and the strongest papers say “the evidence suggests” rather than “it means.” VR Museum Journal is open; pick any viewing spot you like.

U3. Egypt and Mesopotamia this week. Watch for three tools on the Palette of Narmer: hierarchical scale, registers, and composite view; your analysis [due date] should name at least two and say what each one *does*. The cartouche design is your first chance to apply a 5,000-year-old convention to your own name; sign it.

U4. Greece: the two-century sprint from stiff kouros to breathing marble. For the Parthenon Analysis [due date], the magic word is *entasis*: find the places where the building bends so your eye sees it straight. Discussion: how Egyptian and Greek sculptors answered the same question differently.

U5. Rome builds this week: arches, concrete, and an emperor’s image machine. Your analysis [due date] gives you a choice: read the Colosseum as engineering or Augustus as propaganda. Either way, tie every claim to something you can point at. Architecture Journal in VR: stand under something enormous and take a note.

U6. Semester 1’s last content unit: Byzantine gold, Islamic pattern, Gothic light. Choose Hagia Sophia or a Gothic cathedral for your analysis [due date] and explain how the building makes light do theological work. In the closing survey, tell me which work from this semester you’d put in an exhibit; you’ll use that answer next week.

CP1. You are the curator now. Choose 5–7 works from Units 1–6, find the thread that ties them, and build your Virtual Museum Exhibit [due date]. Museum labels are your four-step method in miniature: three sentences that make a stranger stop and look. Public-domain images only, cite each one, and give your exhibit a title you're proud of.

U7. Welcome back, and welcome to the Renaissance. This week: humanism, sfumato, and the geometry trick that fooled Europe's eyes for 500 years. Your analysis [due date] offers the Mona Lisa or the School of Athens; either way, write about what is on the surface, not the artist's biography. Perspective drawing: horizon line, vanishing point, orthogonals; ruler required, subject up to you.

U8. The lights go down this week: Caravaggio's tenebrism, Bernini's marble in motion, Versailles's power made visible. For the analysis [due date], follow the light: where it comes from, where it lands, and why that choice is the whole drama. Chiaroscuro challenge: one deliberate light source, and tell me what it reveals and what it hides.

U9. Three revolutions in one unit: reason (David), passion (Géricault), and the radical act of painting ordinary work (Courbet). The Stone Breakers Analysis [due date] rewards restraint: the painting refuses drama on purpose, so don't add any. Discussion: is honest attention or grand emotion the better teacher?

U10. Out of the studio and into the light. Two weeks only, so start now: choose Monet, Renoir, or Cassatt for your analysis [due date] and get close enough to see the broken brushwork do its optical work. Color & Light Study: catch one real moment of light where you live; a photo and three sentences is all it takes.

U11. The frame breaks this week. You'll meet Cubism, Surrealism, and the question "what counts as art?" through museum links rather than embedded images; that's copyright law working as designed, and your analysis [due date] must link its work the same way: title, artist, date, and a working museum link at the top. In the closing survey, tell me which assignment this year made you proudest.

CP2. The last project is a look back at your own year. Gather your strongest analyses, a comparison, a creation, and write the reflection that ties them together: how your eye changed, with the evidence to prove it. That reflection is the graded heart, and it can only come from you. Table of contents, page numbers, [due date]. It has been a privilege to look at all of this with you.

Situational — mid-unit check-in. "Quick check: if you rated your confidence 1 or 2 on the last unit survey, I've posted a 10-minute refresher on [concept] and my office hours are [time]. This is exactly what they're for."

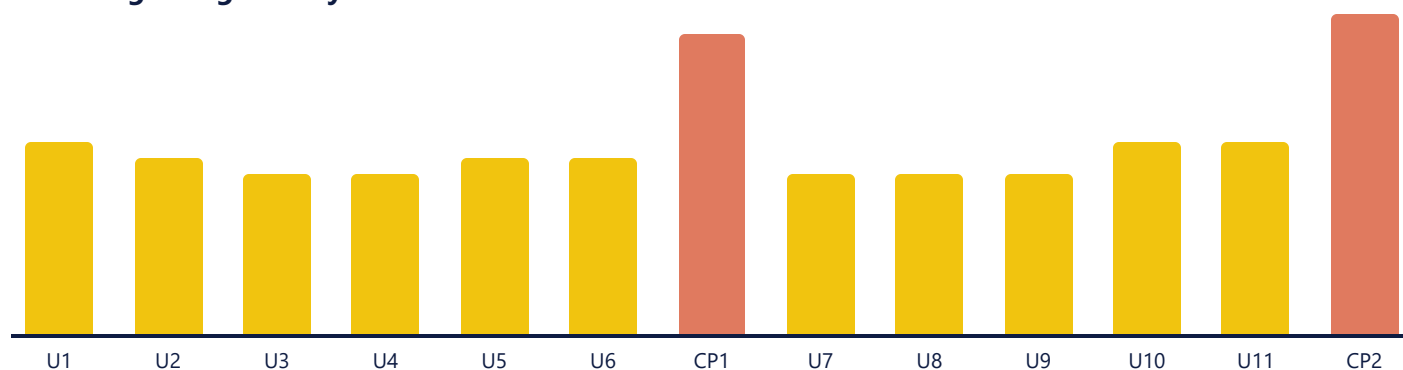
Situational — pre-capstone. "[CP] is due [date]. The most common miss is [selection with no theme / a reflection that stays vague]. Send me your [theme sentence / shortlist] by [day] and I'll tell you if you're on track."

Situational — re-engagement. "[Name], I haven't seen work from you since [item]. No lecture, just a door: the next small step is [specific item], it takes about [time], and I'm at office hours [time] if anything is in the way. School policy counts ten quiet days as an attendance issue, and I'd rather solve it with you now."

11. Teacher workflow & workload map

A normal week, in order: (1) Triage outro analytics from any unit that closed (Section 3; 15–20 min). (2) Batch-grade the open discussion on the 3-level rubric; leave 2–3 public model comments (~2 hrs at cohort scale, spread out). (3) Rubric-grade analysis submissions as they arrive rather than all at the deadline (~5 min each). (4) Post the weekly announcement (Section 10). (5) Answer messages; send the nudges your triage surfaced. Tier-1 items cost ~0 hours (auto/completion); Tier 2 ~2–3 hrs per discussion cycle; Tier 3 is the real spend, concentrated at analysis and capstone deadlines.

Relative grading load by module



Gold = the steady one-analysis-per-unit rhythm (every unit has exactly one 40-pt rubric pass). Coral = the two capstones: **CP1 lands with Q2 close and CP2 with final grades — block real calendar time for both**, and encourage early submission with a “send me your theme/shortlist” checkpoint (Section 10). U10 is short, so its deadlines stack tighter than the 3-week units. Heights are relative estimates from the tiered item counts, not clock promises.

12. Standards coverage: Florida & Texas

This course is built to **CPALMS 0100330** (12 visual-arts benchmarks plus Florida’s embedded K12 expectations). For Texas sections it is mapped against **19 TAC §117.302, Art, Level I** (TEKS, Fine Arts High School, adopted 2013) — Texas has no state-authored art-history TEKS course, and Art, Level I is the standard TEKS alignment target for a one-credit fine-arts course of this kind. Codes stay in this manual only; they never appear on student pages.

12a. Florida (CPALMS 0100330) — by standard

BENCHMARK	SHORT DESCRIPTION	WHERE TAUGHT / ASSESSED	STATUS
VA.912.C.1.3	Use exemplars to formulate criteria for assessing personal work	CP2 reflection explicitly requires two criteria for judging one's own work, learned from studied exemplars, with a piece measured against them (revision 2026-07-13); built toward all year by the creation activities' artist-note self-assessments	COVERED
VA.912.C.1.4	Apply knowledge/context to analyze content and ideas in works	Every unit: lessons, Artwork Spotlights, all 11 analyses	COVERED
VA.912.C.2.4	Classify artworks with accurate vocabulary (movements, styles, techniques)	U1 Elements/Principles; unit quizzes; U4, U8, U9, U10, U11 lessons	COVERED
VA.912.C.2.8	Compare artwork/architecture: technical & utilitarian vs. aesthetic	U3–U11 architecture lessons and every comparison discussion	COVERED
VA.912.C.3.5	Connect visual-arts timelines to other content areas	All comparison discussions; period-context parts of every lesson; CP1/CP2	COVERED
VA.912.C.3.6	Discuss how aesthetics of artworks/utilitarian objects change over time	U3 (architecture/belief), U8 (Baroque→Rococo), U9, U10 transitions	COVERED
VA.912.F.1.5	Create a digital/time-based presentation comparing artists in context	CP1 Virtual Museum Exhibit (anchor) ; CP2 portfolio	COVERED
VA.912.F.2.8	Describe community resources to preserve/exhibit/view art	U2 & U5 VR museum/architecture journals; CP1 curator framing; U11 museum link-outs	COVERED
VA.912.F.3.5	Use cited sources to document research on visual culture	U1 analysis (Works Cited skill step); citation requirements on CP1 & CP2	COVERED
VA.912.H.1.4	Cross-cultural connections among artworks and cultures	U2, U3, U5, U6 (Byzantine/Islamic/Gothic), U8–U11 lessons and discussions	COVERED
VA.912.H.1.9	Significance of major artists/architects/masterworks	Every unit's anchor works, U3–U11 analyses	COVERED
VA.912.H.2.3	Historical/cultural references in commemorative works	U2 Lascaux analysis, U3 Narmer (unification), U5 Augustus/Trajan (imperial commemoration)	COVERED

Florida's embedded ELA.K12.EE expectations (evidence, discussion, format, voice) are carried by the analyses, discussions, and M365-formatted deliverables; MA.K12.MTR habits appear where the course reasons with structure (perspective construction, mosaic grids); ELD.K12.ELL.SI.1 is served by the visual-first lesson design. Note: some teacher guides also cite "VA.912.O.1" and "VA.912.S.1" as applied tags on creation activities; those families are *not* on this course's official CPALMS benchmark list — treat them as supplementary descriptors, not requirements **[VERIFY at deploy, as the U7 guide itself notes]**.

12b. Texas (19 TAC §117.302 Art, Level I) — by student expectation

SE	SHORT DESCRIPTION	WHERE TAUGHT / ASSESSED	STATUS
1(A)	Concepts from direct observation, original sources, experience, imagination	All creation activities work from studied originals + student observation (U8 chiaroscuro from life, U10 light study from a real scene)	COVERED
1(B)	Elements of art (line, shape, color, texture, form, space, value)	Unit 1 (taught explicitly + Design Challenge); applied in every Analyze step	COVERED
1(C)	Principles of design (emphasis, pattern, movement, contrast, balance, proportion, unity)	Unit 1; applied across all analyses	COVERED
1(D)	Judgments about expressive properties using accurate art vocabulary	Interpret + Judge steps of every unit's analysis; vocabulary boxes	COVERED
2(A)	Visual problem-solving for original artwork	11 creation activities (perspective construction, mosaic design, narrative vase...)	COVERED
2(B)	Communicate applications for design solutions	U1 Design Challenge; U5 digital mosaic option; artist's notes explaining choices; thickened by the U3/U5/U6 media option routes (revision 2026-07-13)	COVERED
2(C)	Understanding of copyright and public domain when working from images	Taught operationally all year: PD/CC-only rule with citation on CP1/CP2, U11 link-out policy, image credits modeled on every page	COVERED (a course strength)
2(D)	Create original artwork communicating thoughts/feelings/ideas	All creation activities + Movement-Inspired Artwork (U11)	COVERED
2(E)	Collaborate to create original works of art	CP1 partner-exhibit option for live sections (two curators, one exhibit, 8–10 works); gallery-walk docent comments add a collaborative layer for async (revision 2026-07-13)	COVERED (partner option is live-section; async remains solo-first by design)
2(F)	Media breadth: drawing, painting, printmaking, sculpture, ceramics, fiber art, design, digital	Drawing (U7, U8, U9), painting (U2), design (U1, U3, U4), digital (U5 option, CP1); plus option routes added 2026-07-13: relief <i>printmaking</i> (U3 cartouche), clay/cut-tile <i>relief</i> (U5 mosaic), <i>fiber</i> border (U6 manuscript)	COVERED
3(A)	Compare historical vs. contemporary styles, themes, trends	U11 (modern vs. contemporary discussion) + comparisons across all units	COVERED
3(B)	Characteristics of artwork from a variety of cultures	U2–U6 (prehistoric, Mesopotamian, Egyptian, Greek, Roman, Byzantine, Islamic, medieval European) + global contemporary voices in U11	COVERED
3(C)	Collaborate on community-based art projects	CP1 class gallery walk (revision 2026-07-13): teacher-assembled class gallery of all exhibits; each student visits two classmates' exhibits and leaves a docent comment. Facilitation recipe in the CP1 teacher guide	COVERED
3(D)	Compare career and avocational opportunities in art	"Careers in the world of art" panel in the CP1 project guide (revision 2026-07-13): curator, conservator, registrar, art historian, appraiser,	COVERED

educator vs. avocational paths (docent, collector)

4(A)	Interpret/evaluate/justify artistic decisions incl. museums, exhibits, websites	Every Artwork Spotlight and analysis; U11 museum link-outs; VR museum visits	COVERED
4(B)	Critique method: describe, analyze, interpret intention, evaluate success	The four-step method IS this expectation, taught U1 and used in all 11 analyses	COVERED
4(C)	Construct a physical/electronic portfolio of personal original artwork	OneDrive portfolio saves required on every creation; CP2 compiles them	COVERED
4(D)	Analyze artwork/portfolios/exhibitions to form precise conclusions	CP1 exhibit curation; CP2 portfolio selection + reflection	COVERED

Standards revisions applied 2026-07-13 — all flagged gaps closed. Every gap identified in the pre-publish audit was fixed in the course files that day:

- **Florida VA.912.C.1.3** — the CP2 reflection prompt now requires two named criteria for judging one's own work, learned from studied exemplars, with one piece measured against them (CP2-01 requirement 6; grading note in the CP2 teacher guide).
- **TEKS 2(E) + 3(C)** — the CP1 assignment now includes the **Class Gallery Walk** (teacher-assembled class gallery; every student leaves docent comments on two classmates' exhibits, completion credit) and a **partner-exhibit option for live sections**. Facilitation recipe in the CP1 teacher guide; run the gallery walk as a Canvas Discussion for zero extra grading.
- **TEKS 2(F)** — optional media routes added inside three existing creations: relief *printmaking* on the U3 cartouche, cut-tile/clay *relief* on the U5 mosaic, *fiber* border on the U6 manuscript page. Same points, same rubric; grade the note and the effort, not the craft polish.
- **TEKS 3(D)** — a "Careers in the world of art" panel now sits in the CP1 project guide (curator, conservator, registrar, art historian, appraiser, educator; avocational paths named alongside).

Remaining honest caveat for Texas reviewers: this is an art history and criticism course; §117.302 is written for a studio course, so 2(E)/2(F) coverage is by designed option routes rather than a full studio sequence. The alignment is defensible; it is not a substitute for Art I studio instruction.

13. What makes this course classical & cultivating culture

The classical moves, and where they actually live: wonder before mechanism (every lesson opens on a real artwork with a looking question before any task); primary-encounter with masterworks rather than textbook summaries (the works themselves, embedded PD or linked, are the reading); the Great Conversation made visual (each unit's comparison sets two traditions in dialogue, and the wrap-ups bridge period to period so students watch Renaissance balance become Baroque drama become Neoclassical order); imitatio in the atelier-rung creation activities (students apply a period's real convention to their own subject, never copy a piece, and sign the result); disputatio in the discussions (claim + reasoned reply); and the virtue thread surfacing in outro reflections: perseverance as slow careful looking, honesty as fidelity to what the evidence shows, courtesy toward the cultures studied; named in reflection, never as a moralizing coda.

Culture at a distance: in an async course the culture is made of your public traces. Quote students' good sentences (with their names) in announcements; drop model comments in discussions that name the thinking, not just the effort; keep your own curiosity visible ("I noticed something new in the Géricault this week"); treat the two capstones as celebrations with an audience, not submissions; and hold the standard warmly: the honors bar in this course is evidence-based looking, and students rise to it when they see it praised in each other.

14. Sensitive-content flags & family scripts

Nothing in this course is gratuitous, but art history involves the human body, religious devotion, and hard history. Flags, in course order, with neutral advance-notice scripts you can adapt. Send the general script at course start; use the unit scripts as each unit opens.

WHERE	WHAT
U2 Prehistoric	Venus figurines: unclothed prehistoric fertility figures
U4 Greece	Classical nude sculpture (kouros tradition)
U6 Byzantine/Islamic/Medieval	Sacred art of Christianity and Islam studied side by side as art history
U7–U8 Renaissance/Baroque	Michelangelo's David (nude); Sistine ceiling; intense religious imagery (Caravaggio's biblical scenes, Bernini's Ecstasy of St. Teresa)
U9 Romanticism	Géricault's Raft of the Medusa: a real shipwreck, dead and dying figures; the historical episode involved starvation and desperation at sea
U11 Modern/Contemporary	Students select their own work from major museum collections; contemporary art can raise contested themes. The analysis requires a museum-held work, which bounds the selection

General (course start). "Dear families: this year in Art History and Criticism 1 Honors, scholars study significant works of art from Prehistory to the present as historians and critics. That gallery includes classical and Renaissance sculpture in the nude tradition, sacred art from several faiths studied respectfully as history, and some works born of hard events. Every work is presented in its historical context for a clear learning purpose, using the same masterworks found in any museum or college survey. If you have questions about any unit's content, please reach out; I'm glad to talk through what's coming and why it's there. [Name, contact]"

U9 (before the Raft). "A note on this unit: one of its anchor paintings, Géricault's Raft of the Medusa, depicts survivors of a real 1816 shipwreck, including the dead and dying. We study it because Romantic painters chose real contemporary tragedy as a subject worthy of epic scale, which was itself a revolution. The lesson treats the history factually and the discussion stays on how the painting is made. Questions welcome. [Name]"

U11 (student selection guidance, to students). "Choose a work held by a major museum and linked from its official page. Pick something you can look at long enough to write four honest paragraphs about. If you're unsure whether a work is a good choice, send me the link before you start; that's never a wrong move."

